DAY 24 | PRE-READ

Persuading People, Orchestrating Models

A light read before Day 24. About 15 minutes.

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Why read this?

Tomorrow has two halves. The morning is about people: influencing without authority, negotiating fair agreements and handling conflict. The afternoon is about connecting AI building blocks into reliable pipelines, and working with AI coding assistants.

1. Influence without a title

FDEs rarely manage the people they need help from. The customer's IT team, security team and managers all have their own priorities. Influence comes from three places: being reliable (**credibility**), making a clear case (**logic**), and showing you understand what matters to them (**connection**).

2. Positions and interests

Two people argue over the last orange. One wants the juice, the other wants the peel for baking. If they only argue about who gets the orange (their **position**), one loses. If they ask why each wants it (their **interest**), both win. Good negotiators ask "why?" before arguing about "what".

> **Key idea:** before any negotiation, know your best alternative if you do not agree. It tells you when to say yes and when to walk away.

3. Conflict is not a failure

Teams that never disagree often hide problems. The goal is not to avoid conflict but to handle it well: stay calm, acknowledge feelings, understand the other view, and agree a next step.

4. Building with AI blocks

Real AI applications chain several steps: fetch documents, fill in a prompt, call a model, check the output. Frameworks such as **LangChain** provide ready-made blocks you connect like pipes.

5. AI that writes code

Tools such as **OpenAI Codex** act like a junior developer: you describe a task, they read the code, make changes, run tests and propose the result. Just like with a new colleague, clear instructions and careful review make all the difference.

6. Think about these before class

- Recall a disagreement at work. What was each side's position, and what was their underlying interest?
- Who do you need help from without having authority over them?
- What would you want a new developer to know before touching your code?

Hanashiai (話し合い): talking things through together